Seat No.

NED UNIVERSITY OF ENGINEERING & TECHNOLOGY

FIRST YEAR (TEXTILE/ MATERIALS/ METALLURGICAL/ CHEMICAL/ POLYMER & PETROCHEMICAL/ FOOD/ ELECTRICAL/ COMPUTER SYSTEMS/ ELECTRONIC/ TELECOMMUNICATIONS/ SOFTWARE/ BIOMEDICAL/ COMPUTER SCIENCE & INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY/ PHYSICS/ INDUSTRIAL CHEMISTRY/ COMPUTATIONAL FINANCE/ ECONOMICS & FINANCE/ TEXTILE SCIENCES/ MANAGEMENT SCIENCES/ ENGLISH LINGUISTICS/ DEVELOPMENT STUDIES/ ARCHITECTURE)

FALL SEMESTER EXAMINATIONS 2024

Batch - 2024

Dated:16-12-2024

Time: 3 Hours **Max.Marks:60**

FUNCTIONAL ENGLISH – EA-104/ EA-111/ EA-114

INSTRUCTIONS: Attempt all FIVE questions.

Q1. Give a careful reading to the passage and answer the questions that follow. (14) [CLO-2]

The French philosopher Denis Diderot lived nearly his entire life in poverty, but that all changed one day in 1765. Diderot's daughter was about to be married and he could not afford to pay for the wedding. Despite his lack of wealth, Diderot was well known for his role as the co-founder and writer of Encyclopédie, one of the most **comprehensive** encyclopedias of the time. When Catherine the Great, the Empress of Russia, heard of Diderot's financial troubles, her heart went out to him. She was a book lover and greatly enjoyed his encyclopedia. She offered to buy Diderot's personal library for £1,000—more than $150,000 today. Suddenly, Diderot had money to spare. With his new wealth, he not only paid for the wedding but also **acquired** a scarlet robe for himself.

Diderot's scarlet robe was beautiful. So beautiful, in fact, that he immediately noticed how out of place it seemed when surrounded by his more common possessions. He wrote that there was "no more coordination, no more unity, no more beauty" between his elegant robe and the rest of his stuff.

Diderot soon felt the urge to upgrade his possessions. He replaced his rug with one from Damascus. He decorated his home with expensive sculptures. He bought a mirror to place above the mantel, and a better kitchen table. He tossed aside his old straw chair for a leather one. Like falling dominoes, one purchase led to the next. Diderot's behaviour is not uncommon. In fact, the **tendency** for one purchase to lead to another one has a name: the Diderot Effect. The Diderot Effect states that obtaining a new possession often creates a spiral of **consumption** that leads to additional purchases.

You can spot this pattern everywhere. You buy a dress and have to get new shoes and earrings to match. You buy a couch and suddenly question the layout of your entire living room. You buy a toy for your child and soon find yourself purchasing all of the accessories that go with it. It's a chain reaction of purchases. Many human behaviours follow this cycle. You often decide what to do next based on what you have just finished doing. Going to the bathroom leads to washing and drying your hands, which reminds you that you need to put the dirty towels in the laundry, so you add laundry detergent to the shopping list, and so on. No behaviour happens in **isolation**. Each action becomes a cue that triggers the next behaviour.

Why is this important? When it comes to building new habits, you can use the connectedness of behaviour to your advantage. One of the best ways to build a new habit is to identify a current habit you already do each day and then stack your new behaviour on top. This is called habit stacking. **(471 words)**

i. Use the following words in sentences of your own so as to bring out their meaning in the context: (05)

a) Comprehensive
b) Acquired
c) Tendency
d) Consumption
e) Isolation

How did Diderot's scarlet robe affect his surroundings? (03)
What is "habit stacking" as described in the passage? (03)
How might the concept of habit stacking help someone trying to build new habits? (03)

Q2. Compose a précis of the passage given in Q1. Also suggest a suitable title for it. (10) [CLO-3]

Q3. (a) Compose a paragraph of 70-80 words using the given topic sentence. (08) [CLO-3]

- Mental health awareness is essential for promoting well-being among young adults.

Q3. (b) Write concluding sentences for the given paragraphs: (04) [CLO-3]

1. The rapid pace of technological innovation has revolutionized industries and transformed the way we live. Artificial intelligence, cybersecurity, and virtual reality will continue to shape our futures. Embracing these advancements while prioritizing ethics and responsibility is crucial. It must be kept in mind that technology has both uses and dangers. Using it ethically is important for averting any risks involved.
2. Maintaining a healthy lifestyle requires commitment and balance. By incorporating regular exercise, balanced nutrition, and mindfulness practices into our daily routines, we can reduce chronic disease risk and improve overall well-being. As individuals, we must take responsibility for our health.

Q4. Write an essay of 300-350 words on ANY ONE of the given topics. (12) [CLO-3]

Instructions:

- Use any one pre-writing strategy to brainstorm for ideas.
- Underline the thesis statement.
- Use at least two transition signals/words and underline them.

1. Impact of technology on education
2. Striving to ensure mental health is as important as working to maintain physical health.
3. Social media effects on consumer behaviour
4. Humans are causing accelerated climate change.

Q5. Draft a letter to the Dean of your faculty and propose/recommend the launch of a wellness program for students. As the Head of the Cultural Society at NED University, explain the growing need for such a program due to academic stress and its impact on students' mental and physical health. Highlight the key components of the wellness program such as art therapy workshops, stress-management seminars, peer support groups, and recreational sports activities. Discuss how the program will create a lasting positive impact on students' well-being and academic performance. Make a strong case for its implementation. (12) [CLO-3]

Good luck!